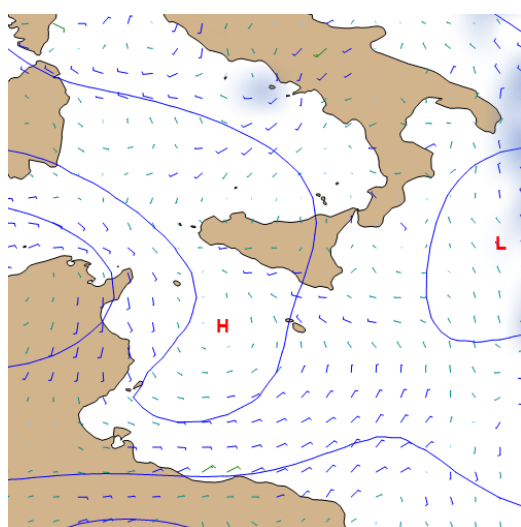


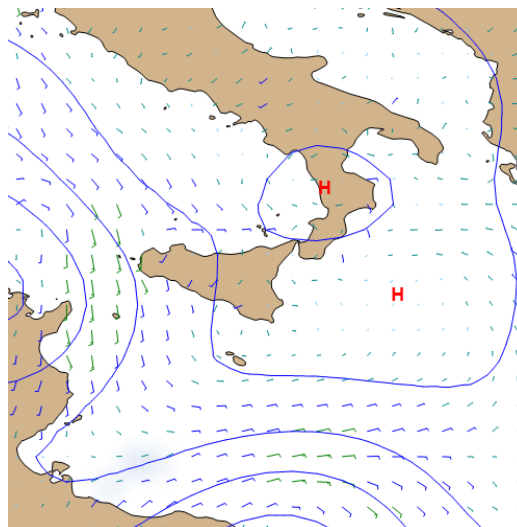
Date: October / 15th /2015
Time: 09:30 AM (07:30 UTC)
Event: Middle Sea Race 2015
Boat: Artemis Open 60



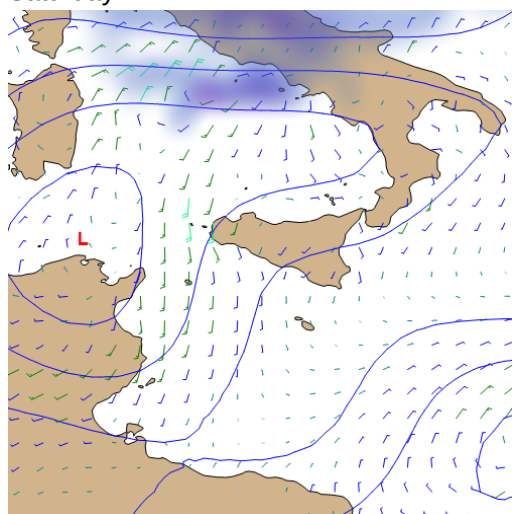
Synopsis: Ridge of High pressures located SW of Sicily on Saturday moving to the south of Italy and Ionian Sea on Sunday. Deepening Low pressures S of Sardinia on Sunday, spreading to the north and west of Sicily on Monday, and possibly to the south of Sicily on Tuesday.



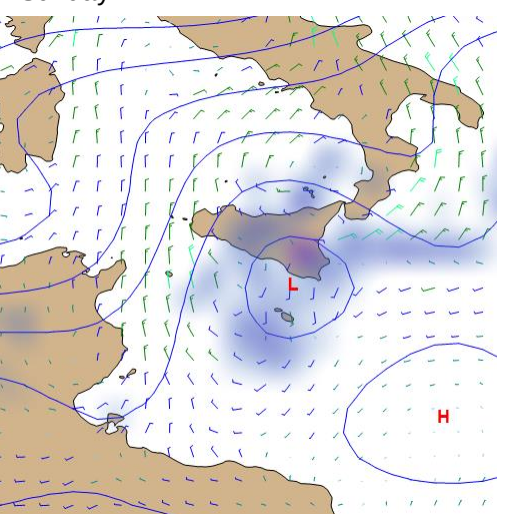
Saturday 14 h



Sunday 14 h



Monday 14 h



Tuesday 14 h

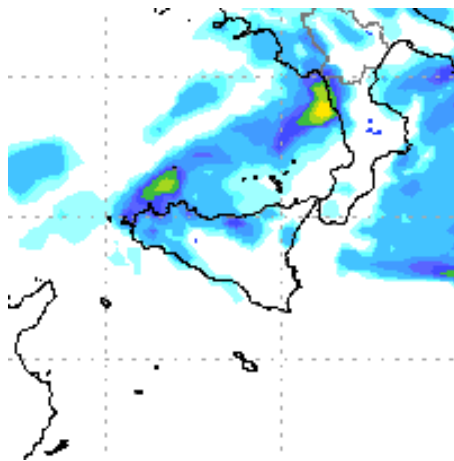
Maps © Ugrib, GFS model, isobar spacing 1 hPa

WARNINGS: Nil.

OUTLOOK FOR THE MIDDLE SEA RACE

Summary: Light winds expected for the first part of the race, due to the Ridge of High pressures located south of Sicily on Saturday and moving eastwards. The Low pressures deepening on the region on Sunday and Monday will cause moderate to fresh periods, but quite variable and unpredictable pattern by the moment in the end.

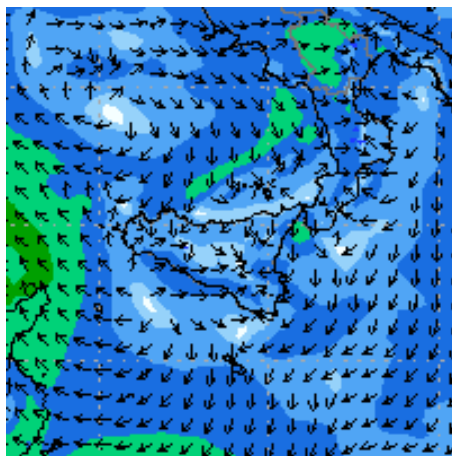
Mostly sunny sky and mild temperatures until Monday, possible showers from Tuesday on, even some storm is possible on Tuesday on the NW part of Sicily.



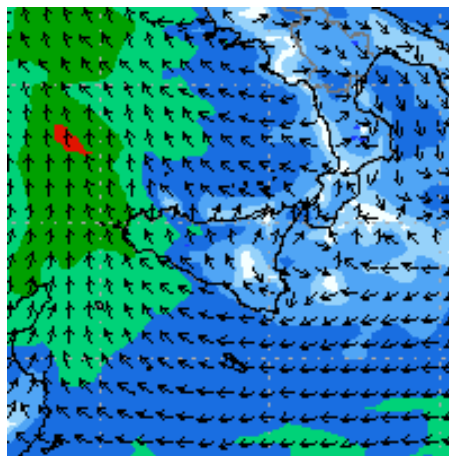
Fcst Precip Tuesday 11 h

Malta to Messina Strait and Stromboli

Gentle to moderate winds expected by the moment from Malta to Portopalo, WNW some 10-12 kts between Malta and Sicily, reaching Portopalo around 18 h, then dropping to light variable W-NW land breeze along the Sicilian coast on Saturday night and Sunday morning. Entering the channel on Sunday afternoon could be done with SE light sea breeze, reaching Messina around 19-21 h. SE some 5-10 kts breeze from the Strait to get Stromboli around 00-02 h (Monday).



Saturday 17 h

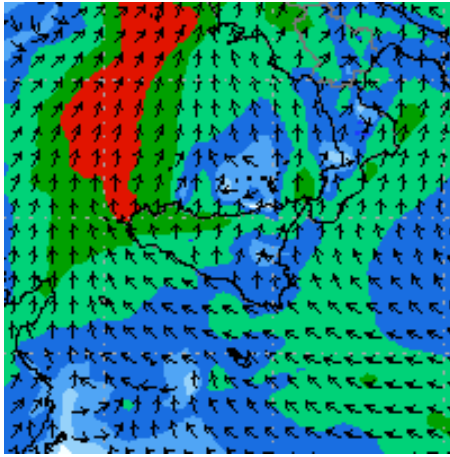


Sunday 11 h

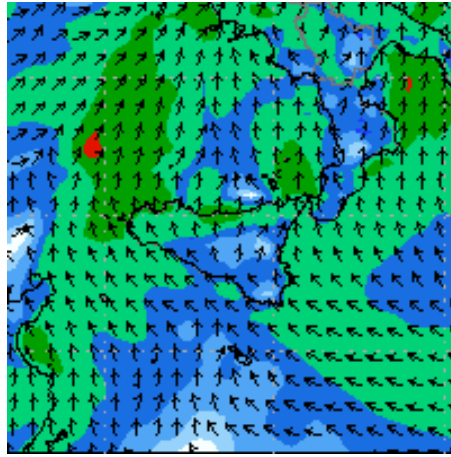
Stromboli to San Vito lo Capo

Big differences on this leg between both models, European model shows the SE gradient dropping in the early morning and becoming southerly gradient by mid morning, increasing a bit as you get close to San Vito around 14-15 h.

GFS model sees San Vito lo Capo reached around 20 h, similar pattern but much weaker speeds.



Monday 14 h



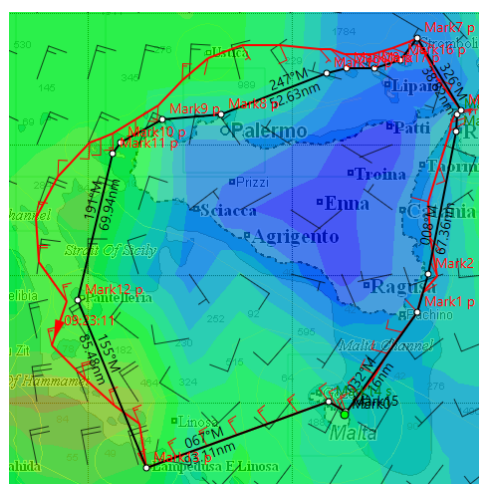
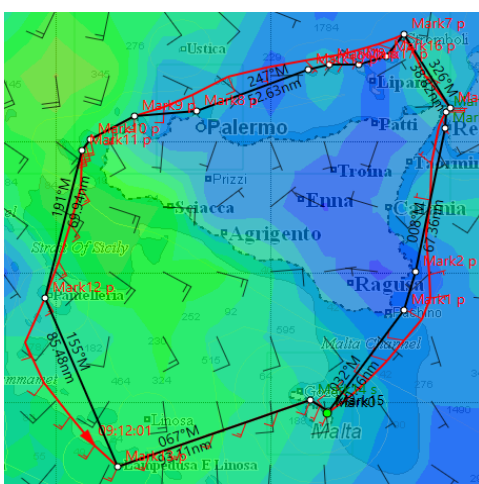
Monday 20 h

San Vito lo Capo - Favignana – Pantelleria- Lampedusa - Malta

Still very undefined scenario for the second half of the race. The Ec model shows from San Vito to Pantelleria moderate SE winds 12-18 kts, dropping and shifting to SW close to Pantelleria around 00 h (Tue)(the front crossing), and increasing gradually to sail from Lampedusa (09 h) to Malta in a 16-18 kts breeze (18h Tuesday).

GFS model shows a weaker pattern to San Vito as said, that is reached around 20 h, shifting to N and increasing to 10-15 kts around Favignana (23 h) and for most of the leg towards Pantelleria, and further increasing to 15-20 kts close to this one, that would be rounded at 07 h (Tuesday). Northerly breeze further increasing to some 20-22 kts going down to Lampedusa (14 h Tuesday), and easing a bit to the end to reach there around 22 h on Tuesday.

So the second half of the race is still quite undefined, these big differences between models mean that the reliability of any of these scenarios is very poor. The next days both models normally will converge to reasonably similar scenarios.



ECMWF routing and wind field 08 h Tue // GFS routing and wind field 08 h Tue

CONCLUSIONS

This is a very complex synopsis as several pressure centres (Ridges and Lows) move around this region during the race. Small changes in the position of any centre can

cause big changes both in direction and speed at any given point. For this reason, the reliability of the forecast this year will probably be quite poor.

In our scenario, quite a long race with light winds in a big part of it. Windier (up to 20-25 kts depending on which model), but quite unpredictable patterns from San Vito Lo Capo onwards, as a Low centre with an embedded front can cross the race track.